boundary before we finished on 281 for five after 43 overs.

I finished unbeaten on 65 from 45 balls, although any frustration at having faced only seven of the 30 balls bowled since the resumption was soothed by the quality of David Miller's hitting.

After all the calculations, New Zealand's target was increased to 298 in 43 overs. We had batted extremely well under intense pressure, paced the innings intelligently, increased the run rate at the right time and posted a decent score. We could have been out of sight if the rain had not intervened, but I was satisfied with our effort.

The home side had dropped no fewer than four catches, and I realised we would need to bowl and field with real intensity and discipline if we were to finish the job and reach the final …

Brendon McCullum is one of the cleanest strikers of a cricket ball in the world. If he gets going, no target is too much. He's not the only dangerous batsman in the New Zealand team, but we need his wicket, and we need it as soon as possible. Dale bowls the first over, and 'Baz' hits the fourth ball for six over extra cover.

I have decided Vern will bowl the second over because he is handy with the new ball, but McCullum is clearly set on attacking everything. He charges the first ball and it goes for four byes. The second goes over long leg for six, the third goes for four past square leg, two dots follow, and the sixth ball goes for four behind square on the leg side. We have conceded 18 off the over. This can happen. The Kiwis are off to a flier.

My mind is racing. We need to keep shuffling the bowlers. Dale bowls the third, and concedes six. Morné bowls the fourth and concedes 14 runs. It is nobody's fault. We need to stay calm. McCullum erupts in the fifth over, hitting Dale for six, one wide, four, six, four, four and a dot. That's 25 runs from the over. The Eden Park crowd is cheering as though the All Blacks have scored a try and somehow manage to maintain the level of noise.